Lockout/Tagout for Facility Equipment

Document	Revision	Effective	Owner
SOP-OPS-001	4	2025-06-15	Northgate Distribution, Facilities

1. Purpose and Scope

This procedure protects employees from unexpected start-up or release of stored energy while servicing refrigeration, compressed air, conveyor and battery charging equipment at all Northgate Distribution sites. It follows the requirements of 29 CFR 1910.147.

2. Roles

- **Authorized employee:** a maintenance technician trained on this SOP who applies locks and tags.
- **Affected employee:** anyone who operates or works near the equipment. They must be told before and after LOTO.
- **Maintenance supervisor:** keeps the lock log and audits this procedure once a year.

3. General Lockout Steps

1. Notify affected employees and the shift lead that the equipment will be shut down.
2. Shut the equipment down with its normal stop control.
3. Isolate every energy source listed in Section 4 for that equipment type.
4. Apply your personal lock and a tag with your name, date and reason at each isolation point.
5. Release or restrain stored energy (Section 4).
6. Verify zero energy: try the start button, then test for voltage with a meter tested on a known live source.
7. Perform the work.
8. To remove LOTO: clear tools, replace guards, tell affected employees, remove your own lock only, then restart.

4. Energy Sources by Equipment Type

Equipment	Energy sources	Stored energy step
CU-400 condensing unit	Electrical disconnect at unit; refrigerant under pressure	Wait 5 minutes for fan capacitors to discharge. Do not open refrigerant lines unless certified under EPA Section 608.
EV-220 evaporator	Electrical disconnect for fans and defrost heaters	Wait 10 minutes for defrost heaters to cool. Heaters can exceed 400F.
AC-75 air compressor	Electrical disconnect; compressed air in receiver and lines; hot oil	Close the discharge isolation valve. Bleed the receiver tank to 0 psig and confirm on the gauge. Let oil cool below 120F.
CD-900 conveyor drive	Electrical disconnect at VFD; gravity and belt tension	Block or chock inclined sections. Release belt tension before removing pulleys.
BC-48 battery charger	480V input disconnect; battery DC output	Disconnect the battery connector from the charger before opening the cabinet.

5. Group Lockout and Shift Change

When more than one technician works on the same equipment, each person applies a personal lock to a group lock box. At shift change the incoming technician applies a lock before the outgoing technician removes theirs, so the equipment is never left without a lock.

6. Removing Another Person's Lock

Only the maintenance supervisor may remove another person's lock, and only after trying to reach that person by phone, confirming they have left the site, and recording the removal in the lock log. The person must be told before they return to work.